STATUS REPORT

Ghana — digital transformation and data governance status report

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ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

Ghana put eleven lots of 5G spectrum on the market on 16 July 2026 at a total reserve of US$230m, and priced it higher for its largest operator: MTN Ghana, the only carrier designated as holding Significant Market Power, carries a 40% premium lifting its reserve to US$50.4m a lot at 700 MHz and US$33.6m at 3 GHz. It follows the National Communications Authority's deletion of the exclusivity clause from NGIC's wholesale 5G licence on 15 July 2026 and the opening of applications two days later, now closing 27 August 2026. The obligation on those licences — 70% population coverage by 6 March 2027 — is band- and technology-neutral, and the Authority has confirmed that for an incumbent it is capable of being met in substantial part from existing deployment.

Reach is not the constraint. 3G and 4G population coverage both exceed 99%, the best in West Africa, while just under 70% of Ghanaians used the internet in 2023 and about 21m people, some 60% of the population, are unique mobile users (2025) against 116.84% SIM penetration in the regulator's Q3 2024 returns. Most of the largest operator's subscribers are still not on 4G — 48% at 30 June 2026, below both smaller rivals.

Fixed lines go the other way, broadband falling 6.83% in the quarter to 216,143 subscriptions in Q3 2024, though under government pressure MTN cut a 100 Mbps unlimited fibre package from GH¢987 to GH¢299 in June 2026. Domestic traffic meets at a single exchange point, GIX, with Google, Meta and Akamai among its peers, and six submarine cables land at Accra — though the Authority's landing-licence page names five providers and neither 2Africa nor Equiano.

A licence is required to operate a submarine cable connecting to a Ghanaian network, and international transmission capacity must be offered to all providers on a cost-based, non-discriminatory basis under the governing electronic communications statute. Universal access is funded from the sector, 5G licensees owing 1% of net revenue to GIFEC. There is no dedicated licence class for community networks, and 36 of 78 authorised internet and public-data providers were not operating in June 2025.

Data Storage

Ghana's largest data centre opened in Accra in October 2025 — Digital Realty's ACR2, carrier-neutral at 1.7 MW of critical IT load and 500 racks and connected to the 2Africa submarine cable. Foreign colocation operators hold the market. Equinix's US$320m acquisition of MainOne, completed on 5 April 2022, brought the Accra data centre and the country's MainOne landing station under US ownership, and Accra also hosts PAIX, Africa Data Centres' ACC1, Etix and an Uptime Tier IV facility run by Onix.

The estate is small. Fewer than ten live commercial facilities carried a few megawatts of live IT load in 2024, with more capacity under construction than was then in service, and Africa Data Centres has announced a build at the Ghana Trade Fair redevelopment site in central Accra designed for several times the country's whole live capacity. No hyperscaler has a region here: AWS, Azure and Google Cloud concentrate their African infrastructure in South Africa and serve Ghana remotely at latencies above 100 milliseconds (2025). Power is the binding constraint on a larger build.

Government hosts its own. The National Information Technology Agency runs a National Data Centre as government's core hosting and disaster-recovery site, with a refresh and upgrade sitting in the World Bank-funded acceleration project's 2026 procurement, and agencies draw on a single shared government cloud platform, hosted on government-owned private infrastructure and delivered as infrastructure-as-a-service (2025).

The rules on where data may sit are sectoral rather than general. The Bank of Ghana's Cyber and Information Security Directive 2026 requires financial data to be held in Ghana, a draft health policy would restrict storing patient data abroad, and the draft data protection bill under consultation would add localisation and cross-border transfer rules the 2012 Act does not contain — while no policy governs where government's own data may be hosted, and the arrangements behind the government cloud exist only as internal documentation (2025). The National AI Strategy 2025–2035 sets no compute capacity target, no siting decision and no budget line for data-centre capacity.

Energy

Solar and other non-hydro renewables supplied 0.71% of Ghana's electricity generation in 2024, against 39% from the Akosombo and Bui dams — 9,893 GWh of 25,550 GWh — with the renewable share in long-term decline as thermal capacity has grown faster than hydro output.

89.5% of the population had electricity in 2023, and the shortfall is rural: 97.5% in urban areas against 77.8% in rural ones in the same year, 19.7 percentage points apart. Ghana's access-to-energy score of 58.3 out of 100 places it 14th of 54 African states, up 9.5 points over 2014–2023, and infrastructure remains one of its three worst-scoring governance sub-categories at 49.9, 16th of 54, even as it drives much of the decade's improvement.

Reliability is the working problem for anyone running equipment. Ghanaian firms averaged 2.9 power outages a month, with 73.8% reporting outages, in the World Bank's 2023 enterprise survey, and much of the country's installed generation does not reach the end user (2025).

Tariffs are reset quarterly by the Public Utilities Regulatory Commission. On the schedule effective 1 April 2026 a lifeline household using up to 30 kWh a month pays GHp 86.90 per kWh with a GHp 213.00 monthly service charge, while 31–300 kWh is charged at GHp 196.88 and consumption above 300 kWh at GHp 260.15, so stepping off the lifeline band more than doubles the unit price.

Off-grid policy has produced little on the ground: around five mini-grids were operational in 2024, serving under 0.5% of the rural population, despite an active government off-grid policy. The Scaling-Up Renewable Energy Programme, launched in May 2025 alongside the Renewable Energy Master Plan, plans mini-grids, solar home systems and net-metered rooftop installations for communities beyond the grid.

Technical Capacity

Government's own account of the first phase of its public-sector reform strategy names delayed fund releases, fragmented coordination, weak performance management and gaps in digital service delivery (July 2026) — a diagnosis it had already been given, the European Union having assessed the National Information Technology Agency in December 2021 as lacking both the technical and integrated digital-government planning skills and the implementation funding required for the platforms the government envisages, with low-quality digital government services the consequence in public institutions.

Outside government the developer community is real but narrow. A 2025 survey of Ghana's tech ecosystem found it overwhelmingly concentrated in Greater Accra, with a substantial share of those working in it belonging to no tech community at all, and the country ranks in the bottom half of Africa on the human resources behind its education system (2023), which is where the pipeline starts. The one statutory route into recognised technical standing runs through the Cyber Security Authority, which accredits cybersecurity professionals and practitioners and certifies cybersecurity products and technology solutions under the Cybersecurity Act 2020.

Government's own measured readiness sits in the 'High' band of the UN's 2024 e-government assessment, while its internal machinery trails the systems it builds for others: the public-service HR system is custom-built and in use but still carries manual, paper-based processes (2025), and the public-service digital skills programme reaches basic digital skills and data literacy through freely available material, its own document unpublished.

Cybersecurity

Ghana scored 99.27 out of 100 in the ITU's 2024 Global Cybersecurity Index, the top 'role-modelling' tier, while incidents reported to its own regulator rose from 1,317 in the first half of 2024 to 2,008 in the first half of 2025, with reported cybercrime losses of GH¢14.94 million over the later period. The Act's licensing regime produced its first published penalties in August 2026: the Cyber Security Authority fined the Office of the Registrar of Companies and a service provider a combined GH¢360,000 — GH¢240,000 against the Registrar in two penalties of GH¢120,000 for engaging an unlicensed cybersecurity service provider, and GH¢120,000 against the provider for operating without a licence. One of the two penalised bodies is itself a state registry, and these are the first penalties published under the Act.

The Cybersecurity Act 2020 (Act 1038), assented on 29 December 2020, makes the Cyber Security Authority a body corporate regulating cybersecurity activity, licensing providers, accrediting professionals, certifying products and regulating owners of critical information infrastructure. Critical information infrastructure is designated by the

Minister on the Authority's advice, gazetted and registered, and its owner must report an incident within 24 hours of detection and submit an audit report — a 24-hour duty the Act extends to the person in charge of any institution in the country, backed by an administrative penalty, so incident counts run against a legal obligation, not voluntary disclosure. The National Identification Authority is itself designated as critical information infrastructure, putting the identity system under the Authority's oversight and periodic compliance audit (2025), and breach notification is layered across the data protection statute, Act 1038 and the central bank's own reporting requirements. A National Cyber Security Policy and Strategy was adopted in 2024, covering cybersecurity, data centres and cloud, data protection, digital identification and payments.

Coverage is uneven. CERT-GH's published constituency is eight sectoral teams, omitting the energy and utilities, health and transportation sectors that Act 1038 itself defines as sectors (October 2021), and the Act makes each sector bear the establishment and running cost of its own team. Direction leans to the security services: the Act's eighteen-member Joint Cybersecurity Committee is drawn overwhelmingly from intelligence, defence and law-enforcement bodies, with the communications regulator, NITA, the data-protection regulator, the central bank and the domain registry holding one seat each. Funding runs on two tracks: a standing Cybersecurity Fund draws on a charge on persons licensed by the Bank of Ghana and a proportion of the fees on all government e-services, and the FY2026 estimates make the Authority 86.0% treasury-funded, GHS 21,801,749 of a GHS 25,346,198 vote.

DPI

Data Exchange

Ghana still has no statute behind an exchange layer: the instrument that would create a National Data Exchange Platform, the National Information Technology Agency's Data Harmonisation Bill 2025, went to public consultation in November 2025 and has not been passed, and the separate Data Exchange Act named in the government's ten-year artificial-intelligence roadmap has neither a published draft nor a timetable.

What exists in the meantime is a Government Service Bus and an interoperability framework that agencies use only partly (2025). Ghana's customs, tax administration, financial management, pension and public investment systems all report exchanging data with other government systems through dedicated interfaces and the bus (2025), and the documentation for most of those systems is held internally rather than published. The framework this was meant to replace, the eGovernment Interoperability Framework of 2009, stalled on funding shortfalls and unclear institutional mandates; procurement for an exchange was re-issued in 2019 and again in 2022 without a clear outcome, leaving cross-government sharing to run through separate sector systems, with Ghana.gov the de-facto catalyst in the framework's place.

The connections that do carry data are bilateral and project-based. The Ghana Card reaches the revenue authority, the health insurance scheme, the driver and vehicle licensing authority, the business registry, mobile money operators and banks through separate APIs and memoranda of understanding, with full synchronisation still in progress (2024), and the pipeline that issues a newborn an identity number is a point-to-point automation between the Births and Deaths Registry and the National Identification Authority rather than a connection through any national exchange (2025). Coverage is uneven even among identity-issuing bodies: the licensing authority verifies biometrically against the Authority, passport integration remains under development, and the Electoral Commission's data is not linked at all (2024). Beyond the centre, the national household registry presents itself as the hub for social protection data, keyed on its own identifiers.

Ghana's most concrete exchange work in 2026 was outside its borders: it joined Smart Africa's cross-border exchange technical assessment mission in Kigali in April 2026, working through PKI trust chains, API contracts and cross-border verification requests.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Looking at a Ghana Card stopped being lawful verification in 2026. The National Identity Register (Amendment) Regulations 2026 (L.I. 2523) came into force on 9 June 2026, and they bar organisations from photocopying, scanning or retaining copies of the card, requiring a real-time biometric match against the National Identification Authority's database — so the card need not be presented at all where verification is available, having become a pointer resolved against the register. Banks, telecommunications operators, hospitals, insurers and government agencies have until 2 November 2026 to integrate, on a sanctions ladder ending in withdrawal of an operating licence.

The system rests on the National Identification Authority Act 2006 (Act 707), the National Identity Register Act 2008 (Act 750) and its 2017 amendment (Act 950), and the National Identity Register Regulations 2012 (L.I. 2111) as amended by L.I. 2356 (2018) and L.I. 2523 (2026). The register is a centralised biometric database serving as Ghana's population register, holding more than 19.5 million enrolments as of May 2026 across 292 centres; children under 15 and Ghanaians abroad remain largely outside it. Non-registration is not an offence, but the card is required for banking, passports, licences, land registration, SIM cards and health cover; first registration is free, while premium, replacement, diaspora and non-citizen cards attract fees, and a 24-hour paid Prestige Centre opened in Accra in August 2026. The number has been the individual taxpayer identifier since April 2021, the Bank of Ghana requires the card for transactions at licensed financial institutions, and it is an ICAO-compliant travel document accepted from ECOWAS states since March 2022. It does not make payments: the Authority stated on 8 April 2026 that the card "has not been activated for financial transaction purposes".

Civil registration underneath is thinner. Birth registration completeness stands at around 70 per cent (2021), since March 2024 births recorded in health facilities have received an identity number at registration, and rural offices still record births on paper. The state keeps ownership of the register under a 15-year partnership to which it had contributed about USD 124 million and the private partner USD 169 million (2025).

Digital Payments and Fintech

Ghana's payment rails are vast and almost entirely single-network: mobile money carried 954 million transactions worth GH¢492.9 billion in June 2026, while the interoperable service handled 33.5 million transactions worth GH¢6.2 billion in the same month, roughly 1.3 per cent of the total. Registered wallets reached 84.6 million by June 2026, of which 26.4 million were active; 75.7 per cent of adults owned a mobile money account (2024).

The infrastructure is the central bank's own: GhIPSS, a Bank of Ghana subsidiary, runs instant pay, mobile money interoperability, e-zwich, the national switch, the clearing house and the GhQR code standard. Person-to-person transfer dominates it: 282.95 million of 290.31 million interoperable transactions in 2025, while business settlement runs over instant pay subject to a GHS 50,000 per-transaction cap. Government both pays and collects on these rails: civil service salaries and pensions run electronically and the LEAP cash grant has disbursed through GhIPSS and e-zwich since 2015, the 99th cycle paying GH¢139.3 million to 350,580 households in December 2025.

The Payment Systems and Services Act 2019 (Act 987) sets consumer protection in sections 44 to 47, requiring every provider to run an internal dispute mechanism with unresolved complaints escalated to the Bank of Ghana for adjudication within 20 days. The Bank publishes an annual payment systems oversight report with self-assessments against the international principles. Its live enforcement front is digital credit: after the regularisation deadline expired on 30 June 2026 it named 20 unlicensed loan applications on 3 August 2026 and cautioned banks and payment providers against processing for them — while the register of licensed providers a borrower would check against was still promised only "in due course" on 20 July 2026.

Ghana hosts the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System, with more than 15 Ghanaian banks live by 2026 though the consumer mobile money leg remains a pilot. MTN completed the structural separation of its mobile money business in the first quarter of 2026, the fintech arm now filing its own accounts and declaring its own dividend, and the electronic transfer levy introduced in 2022 was repealed in April 2025.

Registries

Land is the register Ghana has not managed to build: digitisation has made no progress since February 2025, a USD 85 million deal remained unsigned as of June 2026, and there is no nationally deployed cadastral register distinct from the deeds and title system, leaving the Lands Commission's online services short of national coverage of land rights (2025).

The business register is the opposite case. The Office of the Registrar of Companies runs a national e-portal for name search, reservation and entity registration, separated from the Registrar-General's Department under the Companies Act 2019 (Act 992); its beneficial ownership register is open and integrated with the company register, and the register connects by API to the revenue authority's eTax portal, the National Identification Authority and Ghana Post (2024). An end-to-end digital registration platform and a real-time company and beneficial-ownership verification service for financial institutions were both in pilot in mid-2026. The tax link is administrative rather than automated: businesses must register with the Registrar-General before the revenue authority will issue a taxpayer number, through a co-located one-stop centre rather than data exchange (2021).

Addressing exists on paper more than in use: GhanaPostGPS has covered the country on a five-metre grid since 2017, but few Ghanaians actively use their digital address, even though a digital address has been a mandatory field on business registration since March 2019.

The electoral register rivals the identity register for reach and is deliberately kept apart from it. The Electoral Commission's certified 2024 register held 18,774,159 valid voters, nearly all with biometric data, yet the Ghana Card is only one of several accepted proofs of identity for registration, Parliament having rejected the Commission's 2023 attempt to make it the sole document, and no technical link joins the two databases. For social protection the national household registry is the single targeting database behind LEAP, school feeding and health insurance, serving more than 15 government and partner programmes since 2019. A further layer sits outside the identity stack: the driver and vehicle licensing authority is building an electronic number-plate system, piloting from August 2026 towards nationwide implementation in 2027.

Sectoral management information systems

Ghana's health information system had to be rebuilt after it failed. The Health Minister disclosed in October 2025 a failed $77 million health-data contract under which roughly 15 million patient records had to be reconstructed, and the ministry ordered a nationwide rollout of a replacement platform. Electronic records are concentrated in district and regional hospitals rather than rural facilities, and point-of-care tools such as the DHIS2 e-Tracker remain partially and inconsistently used even inside pilot facilities (2025), with rural primary care still recording on paper registers. Education is a once-a-year capture rather than a live record: the school census has been digitised since 2022, head teachers submitting an annual return through an app or web platform.

The financial and revenue back office is the strongest part of the estate. Ghana runs an integrated financial management information system on commercial software covering treasury and budget preparation across central and local government and a treasury single account extensively used by ministries, departments and agencies, though the system does not track public spending to programme level. Payroll and human resources are custom-built, with manual and paper-based processes persisting in parts of the HR system; both the HR system and the pension and social insurance system use the national identity number as their identifier rather than keeping their own. In customs, the revenue authority's automated valuation risk system was piloted in early 2026 and fully deployed from March, having analysed about 366,000 import declarations by 17 July 2026, a quarter of them referred for officer review, and the taxpayer register is being moved onto a new integrated tax administration system.

Justice, policing and employment are where the estate thins to nothing. The court automation system launched in 2019 has stalled on unreliable connectivity, inadequate funding and continued manual processes in many courts; rural police stations record complaints on paper case files physically transported to Accra for later digitisation, with only about 3,700 historical fingerprint sets digitised; and the labour market information system is a standalone departmental portal, with a consolidating national platform still under development and testing in February 2026.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Ghana is rebuilding its front door rather than extending it: a shake-up of Ghana.gov began in May 2026 to re-architect the platform around simpler citizen journeys, taking GOV.UK and Rwanda's Irembo as models, while the same platform is being expanded to carry about 16,000 services with full integration to the national identity credential, funded by the $200 million World Bank Ghana Digital Acceleration Project. The portal is already transactional to the point where citizens can complete services online end to end, company formation among them (2025), and sectoral portals cover tax, social protection and public jobs. It is not a single front door: the driver and vehicle licensing authority has stayed off the platform and its integration with other government systems remains partial.

Where a business deals with the state, the machinery is further along. The revenue authority's taxpayers' portal and app let filers pay by mobile money, card, USSD or bank, issue tax clearance certificates only through the portal, and are mandatory for excise taxpayers and for businesses above GHS 5 million in annual revenue, with separate e-VAT and e-invoicing portals alongside. Procurement is mandatory on the Ghana Electronic Procurement System by direction of the Finance Minister, which the Public Procurement Authority says removes physical contact between procuring entities and suppliers end to end, with evaluations run against pre-disclosed criteria and is integrated with the national payment system so transactions settle through it. The Interior Ministry added its own online services portal, integrated with identity databases, in December 2025.

Coordination has an owner but not a single operating model. An established institution holds both the coordination and the audit mandate for government digital transformation (2025), yet digital transformation is not run as one government across ministries and there is no national citizen participation or e-consultation channel at all. Measured readiness is respectable: Ghana scored 0.5824 on the UN E-Government Development Index in 2024, in the "High" band. The gap this leaves is with the people the estate is for: as at December 2021 trust in government e-services was generally low and most Ghanaians were unaware the services existed.

Governance

Legislation and regulation

Ghana's newest binding digital instrument was in force five weeks before it was announced: the National Identity Register (Amendment) Regulations 2026 (L.I. 2523) were signed on 2 March 2026, gazetted on 27 March and commenced on 9 June, and the National Identification Authority publicised them on 16 July. They amend L.I. 2111 of 2012 under the National Identity Register Act 2008 (Act 750), and the transactions on which biometric verification bites are set by Regulation 7 of the 2012 regulations, not by the amendment. The identity stack is Act 707 of 2006, Act 750, the National Identity Register (Amendment) Act 2017 (Act 950) and L.I. 2111 as amended by L.I. 2356 (2018) and L.I. 2523, and breach is punishable by 500 to 2,000 penalty units for an organisation.

The wider regime is a stack of framework statutes rather than a code: the Electronic Communications Act 2008 (Act 775) covers telecommunications, spectrum, quality of service and universal access, the National Information Technology Agency Act 2008 (Act 771) reaches from data centres to digital signatures and e-waste, and the Data Protection Act 2012 (Act 843) establishes the Data Protection Commission. The Cybersecurity Act 2020 (Act 1038) is drafted to be read together with eleven named enactments including both, and it carries production orders, interception powers and a data-retention duty on service providers and a child online protection chapter.

No statute establishes cross-government data exchange: the Data Harmonisation Bill 2025 went to public consultation in November 2025 and has not passed. Ghana has a Virtual Asset Service Providers Act, but no gazetted text of it is published online and no licensing dates or licensee numbers have been reported. Newer regulation arrives by notice: digital credit is licensed under the Non-Bank Financial Institutions Act 2008 (Act 774) read with a dozen other enactments, on paid-up capital of GHS 2,000,000; the regularisation deadline elapsed on 30 June 2026 and the Bank named twenty unlicensed lending applications on 3 August 2026, while the register of licensed ones has yet to appear.

Strategies, plans and policies

The strategy that would make digitisation the organising goal of the whole Ghanaian state is still a draft: the second National Public Sector Reform Strategy, which puts full digitisation of every public service at its centre with national identity as the spine, cleared a stakeholder validation workshop in Accra on 30 July 2026 and still needs sign-off from the Chief of Staff, Cabinet and Parliament. It runs to seven pillars, 27 programmes and 135 activities over five years and is unusually candid about its predecessor, naming delayed fund releases, fragmented coordination, weak performance management and gaps in digital service delivery as phase-one failures — with sustainable financing made a pillar in its own right in consequence. The minister's stated test of success is service quality as citizens experience it rather than counts of completed activities.

That draft addresses the standing weakness. Ghana has a current digital transformation strategy with a named lead, but the whole-of-government machinery behind it is only planned or in draft, and digital transformation is not run as one government across ministries (2025). The National Artificial Intelligence Strategy 2025–2035, published in December 2025, carries digital infrastructure and inclusion as its third pillar and data access and governance as its fourth; it was launched publicly in April 2026 and followed by a ten-year implementation roadmap in July. Around them sit a National Data Strategy validated in July 2024, a Government Enterprise Architecture Framework of 2022 and a Digital Economy Policy and Strategy adopted late in 2024, while the 2024 National Cyber Security Policy and Strategy does duty for data centres and cloud services.

Commitment is easier to find than publication. The documents behind the digital transformation strategy, the data-governance arrangements and the public-service digital skills programme are not published, and the data-governance function itself sits inside another institution rather than standing alone (2025). There is no open source policy for government software, and the oldest open-data instrument on the record is the sectoral GHEITI policy of December 2016, which sets no publication timetable, names no open licence and appoints no owner for any commitment.

Regional collaboration

The regional rail Ghana's identity and free-movement arrangements run on now stops short of three of its neighbours: Burkina Faso, Mali and Niger severed their ECOWAS ties in 2024 and are building a rival Alliance of Sahel States identity bloc, with a common AES biometric passport launched in January 2025 and AES-aligned national ID cards following in Burkina Faso and Niger. Within what remains of the community, ECOWAS treats foundational digital identity as infrastructure for free movement, and the ECOWAS–World Bank WURI programme validated a cross-border interoperability strategy and a 2026 work plan at its second Supervisory Committee meeting in March 2026 — a plan for mutual recognition rather than a working one, though the Ghana Card already serves as a travel document for Ghanaians entering from ECOWAS states.

Payments reach further than identity does. Ghana hosts the headquarters of the Pan-African Payment and Settlement System and has banks settling cross-border payments in local currency on it, with one commercial bank putting the rail inside its mobile app in July 2026 and a Nigeria-to-Ghana corridor settling in naira under pilot. Ghana also operates a fintech licence-passporting arrangement with Rwanda whose memorandum neither central bank has published. On the continental instruments, Ghana ratified the African Union's Malabo Convention in 2019, one of a small group of African states to do so, and frames its digital-governance work around participation in the AfCFTA Protocol on Digital Trade and WTO digital-trade discussions.

The regional layer is committed to more than it is paid for. ECOWAS ministers adopted a Digital Sector Development Strategy for 2024–2029 at Cotonou on 4 October 2024 and committed member states in January 2026 to "remove digital borders" through interoperable fintech, a unified identity layer and rural broadband, and they directed full implementation of the roaming regulation by the end of 2025 without publishing any assessment of compliance. Yet the Community budget for 2026–2028 carries no disaggregated digital appropriation anywhere in its expenditure structure, and its only ICT-named programme line has a nil allocation throughout, against a Community Levy supplying UA 195,850,000 of the Commission's UA 411,724,082 income in 2026.

Standards

Ghana spent April 2026 working out how its systems would talk to other countries' while its own agencies still do not all talk to each other, joining a Smart Africa Digital Exchange technical assessment mission in Kigali that worked through PKI trust chains, API contracts, cross-border verification-request processing and incident response toward a federated exchange architecture. At home the picture is older and slower. The e-Government Interoperability Framework launched in 2009 stalled on funding shortfalls and unclear institutional mandates and never became the working exchange layer, leaving government data fragmented and decentralised across agencies; version 2.0 of the framework was still under stakeholder review in 2024. A framework and a Government Service Bus are in operation but only partially used across agencies (2025), and legacy systems have not been retired onto the exchange platform.

Where standards are enforced, it is through the money. Public procurement runs on an electronic system covering online tendering and contract management, interfaced with other government systems and used to enforce procurement standards, and the financial management system applies a standardised budget and accounting classification at both central and sub-national level. Trust services have a statutory home without a published standards regime: Act 771 gives the National Information Technology Agency functions over digital signatures, while the Cyber Security Authority accredits practitioners and certifies products and no one may provide a cybersecurity service without its two-year, non-transferable licence. Ghana has no open source policy for government software (2025). Service quality is held to published numbers only where a licence says so, as in the 5G conditions specifying cell-edge downlink speeds at 85% location probability under busy-hour loading, verified by drive testing, crowd-sourced measurement and site audits. Regionally, the telecommunications regulators' association finalised technical reports on 5G, subsea-cable resilience, cybersecurity and consumer protection in April 2026, intended to harmonise rules rather than to bind.

Data protection

Ghana's data-protection regulator is paid for by the sector it regulates: the Data Protection Commission received no Government of Ghana treasury money in FY2026, its entire GHS 9,720,400 budget being internally generated funds for a budgeted staff of 39, 0.77% of the communications ministry's vote, while the cyber regulator on the same programme is funded from the Consolidated Fund and the programme they share is appropriated undivided.

The Data Protection Act 2012 (Act 843) establishes the Commission, requires data controllers to register and grants rights of access, correction and erasure, and breach notification is already mandatory across three instruments — under Act 843 to the Commission and to data subjects, under Act 1038 within 24 hours, and immediately to the Bank of Ghana. Its weak point is the consent model, which presumes a single legible disclosure moment and carries no multi-party rule for manufacturer, connectivity-provider and cloud-platform chains processing the same data. A draft Data Protection Bill 2025 would add a 72-hour breach deadline with administrative penalties and cross-border transfer rules for sensitive categories, and remained in draft in 2026. The National AI Strategy recommends re-founding the Commission as a Data Protection Authority, but as at August 2026 that carries no bill, no timetable, no funding line and no transitional arrangement.

Enforcement is asserted rather than evidenced. A Governing Board chaired by Teki Akuetteh was sworn in during August 2025, the Commission has run a nationwide enforcement drive since August 2023 and a privacy awareness campaign across all sixteen regions, and compliance is monitored — but neither the authority nor the wider regime publishes reports on its oversight activity. Other regulators fill the space: the Bank of Ghana characterises unlicensed digital lending as "significant violations of customer data privacy, consumer protection, and established regulatory standards", and payment-specific duties run under section 34 of the Payment Systems and Services Act 2019. Sharing of register data by agencies requires prior approval, a contract and certification, with a data-sharing policy still in draft. Sovereignty is the same shape: strong on paper, with enforcement of cross-border transfer restrictions needing strengthening (2024).

Public debate and participation in policymaking

Ghana's transparency regulator fined a large part of the state at once: on 5 August 2026 the Right to Information Commission imposed GH₵20,000 administrative penalties on 254 ministries, departments, agencies and assemblies under section 77(1) of the Right to Information Act 2019, for missing the statutory deadline to file their 2025 annual reports. The law is in force with a working mechanism for requesting public records, but what comes out the other side is thin: accessibility of public records and disclosure of them both sit around half marks in the 2024 Ibrahim Index (2023), and the open data portal was populated by well under half the targeted agencies on the government's own 2024 account.

There is no standing channel through which the public reaches policy. Ghana has no citizen participation platform — no online consultation or e-participation channel at national level and no feedback mechanism through which service complaints reach government and are answered (2025), though the government reports that citizens are consulted in the design of the national service portal and its sectoral portals. Consultation is convened case by case and reaches organised interests first: the communications ministry took industry comment on a draft digital-economy fund bill at a stakeholder session in July 2026, and the statutory duties to hold public hearings on first-instance licence applications and publish licence terms sit on the communications regulator alone.

The debate that does happen is loud and largely external. Think tanks have attacked the One Million Coders programme for lacking a route from training to jobs, and civil society has pressed publicly for community-network licensing reform. The space for it is good by continental standards and narrowing: digital freedom scores 86.0 and ranks 4th of 54, down 7.7 points over the decade to 2023, and media freedom 69.7 and 7th, down 11.6 points. The state also holds power to block, filter and take down content, enforced at 100 penalty units for each day a service provider fails to comply, and the cyber regulator has announced that it will itself certify trained community journalists into a standing press corps on the cyber beat.

Inclusion

Digital divides

Ghana's gender divide moved in two directions at once: between 2018 and 2022 the gap in phone ownership of any kind narrowed from 13 percentage points to 7, while the gap in smartphone ownership widened from 6 points to 17, with 63% of men against 46% of women owning a smartphone (2022). Convergence on the device that makes calls has been accompanied by divergence on the device that reaches the internet.

The settlement divide runs through the handset rather than the connection. Smartphone ownership was 58.4% urban against 28.1% rural, while basic-phone ownership inverted at 61.3% rural against 38.7% urban (2019). The same regulator survey found 16.8% of households with internet access at home, against 73.8% owning a television, and 7.9% of people aged five and over owning a computer of any kind — 5.1% a laptop and 1.6% a desktop (2019). Nothing published since measures the country on the same cut.

The policy instruments barely see the gender line: one of the eighteen priority areas in the ICT for Accelerated Development policy addresses gender equity, and the 2020 Digital Financial Services Policy carries no gender-disaggregated indicators (July 2026). Fieldwork behind that reading found women's handsets were most often gifts from male partners, chosen by the giver rather than the user (2026).

The machinery meant to close the gap is thin. The statute behind the universal access fund sets no rate, no base and no floor for the levy that finances it, leaving the charge to individual licences; the regulator's register shows the internet licence class created for rural service with a single authorised provider it records as not operational (June 2025); and rural electricity access still trails urban by a wide margin (2023).

Access to services

Equal access to public services in Ghana has not moved in a decade: it scored 58.0 out of 100 in the 2024 Ibrahim Index, 10th of 54 African states, a change of -0.1 points over 2014-2023, while the wider inclusion and equality sub-category rose 5.2 points to 69.3 and 3rd of 54 (2023). Inclusion overall is rising; equal access to services is not.

Sections 23 and 24 of the Electronic Communications Act 2008 define universal service to include free emergency-number access and provision enabling persons with disability to make and receive calls, and universal access to include community broadband, signal throughout remote regions, and the connection of schools, universities, health facilities and telecentres.

The Ghana Card gates ordinary transactions — banking, passports, land registration, SIM cards and health insurance — though not registering is no offence. First registration is free at district offices, while replacement, diaspora and non-citizen cards attract fees, and a 24-hour centre in Accra has charged for its services since 1 August 2026. How easily Ghanaians say they can obtain an identity document is among the country's ten most deteriorated measures of the decade (2023), and in the Electoral Commission's 2023 registration exercise most new registrants proved who they were through two guarantors rather than with a card.

Borrowers cannot check a lender: the Bank of Ghana tells the public to deal only with licensed digital credit providers while undertaking to publish the register of them "in due course", without a date (August 2026). What it has published instead is a blacklist of twenty unlicensed loan apps (August 2026).

Accessibility is still in draft: a Bank directive circulated in October 2024 would require financial service providers to offer accessible physical and digital channels, voice controls, braille keypads, accessible ATMs and sign language support, and people with disabilities hold mobile money accounts at markedly lower rates, women with disabilities least of all. The service portal and the tax, social protection and jobs portals are assessed as reaching ordinary users (2025), but no channel exists through which a complaint about a service reaches government and is answered (2025).

Technology

AI

The only artificial intelligence Ghana's government has running at scale collects tax: the Ghana Revenue Authority's Publican AI Trade Solution was piloted in January and February 2026, fully deployed at Customs from March, and had analysed about 366,000 import declarations by 17 July 2026, 24% of which tripped more than one valuation risk indicator and were referred for officer review. Assessed customs collections since deployment rose 17.5% against only a 6.3% rise in importers' own declared CIF value (July 2026), making the gain re-assessment rather than trade growth. Beyond revenue, government's use of artificial intelligence had not reached citizen-facing service channels (2025), the data exchange hub named as the backbone for data quality, fraud detection and analytics across government does not exist, and the data-sharing statutes the implementation roadmap names have not been enacted.

The policy is younger than the system. Ghana's National Artificial Intelligence Strategy runs 2025–2035, was published in December 2025 by the Ministry of Communication, Digital Technology and Innovations, and rests on eight pillars — not the 2023–2033 window that has circulated — and was launched publicly in Accra on 24 April 2026 with President Mahama presiding. It proposes a National AI Fund seeded at GHS 5bn over 2025–2030 and scaling to GHS 15bn over 2030–2035, and a Responsible AI Authority to be stood up within the strategy's first year and reviewed at three; the ministry's own account of the launch names no money at all, and the strategy sets no compute capacity target, no siting decision and no budget line for data-centre capacity. A ten-year implementation roadmap followed in July 2026, at a summit where UNESCO's Accra head warned that AI strategies without funding and execution are "shell documents".

The first sectoral instrument, still a draft, is in health: the Ministry of Health presented a National AI Health Policy in Ho on 5 August 2026 covering the whole lifecycle of a health AI system, from approval and procurement through validation and human oversight to accountability, against seven strategic objectives, but no draft text, adoption route, timetable, costing or implementing body had been established as at August 2026.

ICT Industry

Ghana's ICT sector has been measured properly once, and it shrank as a share of the economy in every year of that measurement: 3.1% of GDP in 2010, falling through 2.8%, 2.7% and 2.5% to 2.2% in 2014, even as the sector's gross value added grew from GHS 1,411.2m in 2010 to GHS 2,489.3m in 2014. Telecommunications carried more of that value added than ICT manufacturing, ICT wholesale and retail trade or other ICT services, and the telecoms market remains one operator's: Ghana has been elevated to a major subsidiary of MTN Group alongside South Africa and Nigeria (February 2026), and at that operator data has passed voice, at 58.7% of service revenue in the six months to 30 June 2026.

The domestic sector around it is wide and thinly capitalised. The Ghana Hubs Network counts over 103 technology and innovation hubs across the country's 16 regions (2024), while Ghanaian startups raised around USD 52m in equity in 2025, or about USD 90m including debt, down on the year. Company formation and registration can be completed online end to end, but the conditions the sector trades in have not improved: Ghana's economic diversification score fell 7.4 points over 2014–2023 to 54.7 out of 100, leaving it 37th of 54 African states and marking its weakest showing in the business and labour environment, and firms still lose power most months. Ghanaian firms do export what they build: Margins ID Group, which produces the Ghana Card, won the contract to build and operate The Gambia's national identity system (January 2026), and CSquared has built metro fibre across the four largest cities.

Innovation ecosystem

Ghana has the whole apparatus of an innovation policy and ranks 101st of 139 economies in WIPO's Global Innovation Index 2025. The World Bank's 2025 assessment finds a startup or innovation policy, public financing or SME support for startups, and public-private partnership arrangements for online service delivery, alongside a public sector innovation strategy and an established body whose remit covers digital skills and public service innovation; against that, government software has no open source policy. New things do come from the private side: the Accra startup KutanaPay, founded in 2023, runs a milestone-based escrow platform for cross-border trade in which the buyer's funds release only when both parties confirm shipment or delivery (July 2026).

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

Ghana's largest data centre and one of its submarine cable landings are American-owned: Digital Realty's ACR2, opened in Accra in late 2025, and the country's MainOne landing station, which Equinix took over with its acquisition of MainOne as part of that company's first African footprint. The US Development Finance Corporation has signalled intent to help finance Africa Data Centres' planned facility at the Ghana Trade Fair redevelopment site in central Accra, which would be that operator's first in the country.

Among the hyperscalers, Google's artificial-intelligence research centre in Accra, first announced in 2018, has been joined by an AI Community Centre in the city, the company's first on the continent. Microsoft's presence reaches into the state: Ghana's national computer emergency response team names Microsoft and the Ghana–US SGI cooperation among its affiliations, and works with the Shadowserver Foundation on proactive notification.

American public funding in the digital field is older and smaller than the commercial footprint. USAID's US$9 million Evaluate for Health task order ran from 2014 to 2020 on health data collection and the evaluation and use of the health management information system, and has closed; the Hewlett Foundation, a private US funder, committed US$1 million over 2021-2025 to strengthen the use of data in monitoring Ghana's progress against the Sustainable Development Goals. American interest in the current legislative round is organised through business rather than aid: the US Embassy, AmCham Ghana and American Tower Corporation attended the Ministry of Communication's stakeholder session on the draft Digital Economy Fund bill on 27 July 2026.

China activities

Ghana now has a bank clearing renminbi directly to China. Stanbic Bank Ghana became the first bank in the country to offer clients direct access to China's Cross-Border Interbank Payment System (August 2026), following Bank of Ghana approval, so remittances, tuition, medical payments and trade can settle in RMB straight from cedi accounts without a correspondent bank in between. The architecture around it was assembled outside Ghana: the People's Bank of China authorised Standard Bank Group and ICBC jointly as the Renminbi Clearing Bank of Africa in June 2026, and Ghana is one of six African markets in Standard Bank's CIPS rollout, a group that had passed CNY 8 billion in China cross-border payment transactions (July 2026).

The lending footprint is older and concentrated in three years. China Eximbank is Ghana's largest single official source of tracked digital-sector external finance, with five loans signed between 2018 and 2020 covering distance learning at five tertiary institutions and at the Institute of Local Government Studies, rural telephony, national-security communications and the upgrading of technical and vocational institutes; the three largest fund contracts with Huawei, China National Technical Import and Export Corporation, China Machinery Engineering Corporation and AVIC International. Phase 2 of the ALPHA national-security communications network rests on a preferential buyer's credit against a Huawei and China Machinery Engineering Corporation contract, and the Rural Telephony and Digital Inclusion Project on a Sinosure-insured buyer's credit against a Huawei and CNTIC contract to build wireless networks in communities where mobile operators do not go.

Those credits sit in the class of debt Ghana stopped paying. The December 2022 sovereign default suspended service on the Eurobonds, commercial loans and most bilateral loans, the China Eximbank ICT, distance-learning and national-security communications credits among them. Regionally, the ECOWAS Commission headquarters handed over in Abuja on 28 April 2026 is a China-aid building, presented by Beijing as an outcome of the FOCAC "Ten Partnership Actions".

EU activities

European digital work in Ghana runs through member states rather than through Brussels. The European Union's 2021-2027 programme for Ghana sets no digital priority area and makes no digital allocation, treating digital as transversal across green growth, sustainable cities and governance, so Ghanaian govtech is paid for out of other sectors' envelopes.

The most active bilateral is Czech. Czechia donated forensic hardware and software worth almost GH¢450,000 to Ghana's Police Cybercrime Unit in May 2026, and its Transformation Cooperation Programme funds the National Community Media Cyber Capability Building Project, implemented by the Africa Center for Digital Transformation with the Cyber Security Authority — so public cyber awareness is being built through community media and a foreign donor rather than inside the state. Germany's BMZ is the other standing presence, funding a 2023-2026 programme on digital transformation for inclusive entrepreneurship aimed at unregistered micro-enterprises, and earlier a project with AFOS/BKU and the University of Cape Coast to let the university and others run practice-oriented ICT qualification programmes.

European bodies also sit in the policy layer and in the identity supply chain. Ghana's National Data Strategy, validated in July 2024, was developed with Smart Africa, the European Union and GIZ, and the national computer emergency response team names the Council of Europe's GLACY+ programme among its affiliations. Denmark's development finance institution took an equity stake in Intelligent Card Production Systems in Accra (2015), the plant that produced the biometric Ghana Card and digital vehicle registrations for the National Identification Authority.

India activities

No Indian state or Indian-financed digital infrastructure, financing commitment or bilateral technology agreement with Ghana was on record as at August 2026.

Gulf/UAE activities

No Gulf or Emirati digital infrastructure, financing commitment or bilateral technology agreement with Ghana was on record as at August 2026.

Capacity

Literacy

Equality is the weakest part of Ghana's education record and the part that has not moved: 46.6 out of 100 in the 2024 Ibrahim Index, 30th of 54, and up 0.3 points across 2014-2023 (2023), against an education sub-category that gained 9.4 points over the same decade to reach 60.5 and 16th place, one of the strongest drivers of the country's decade improvement. The pattern repeats in the teaching base: human resources in education scores 72.5 and rose 14.0 points, yet ranks only 33rd of 54 (2023). The average is improving faster than the distribution.

Basic use is wide. The 2021 census found 80.4% of people aged six and over had used an ICT device in the previous three months and 68.6% had used the internet (2021), with personal computer ownership marginal alongside it. What people do with a device tracks their work rather than their age, with teachers and nurses ranging across markedly more applications than adolescents (2026). In schools the hardware has arrived ahead of the connection: One Teacher, One Laptop had distributed 280,000 laptops by June 2024 without matching investment in school Wi-Fi, and school-wide Wi-Fi heads seven recommendations put to government in July 2026 on which no ministry response is on record.

What children are taught is being rewritten around this. On 20 July 2026 the National Council for Curriculum and Assessment announced a completed revision of the kindergarten-to-JHS basic school curriculum adding coding, artificial intelligence, electronics and TVET, framed as a "Smart Start" STEM integration with added ethics and civic content. Adult literacy work runs mostly through campaigns: the Data Protection Commission's nationwide privacy awareness campaign across all 16 regions (September 2025), and the Bank of Ghana and Securities and Exchange Commission's virtual-asset literacy initiative, which reached Ashanti in August 2026 with teaching in schools, marketplaces and churches.

Training and skills

Ghana's flagship One Million Coders programme was criticised in March 2026 by IMANI's Franklin Cudjoe for lacking a strategy to convert training into jobs, and the announcements since have kept its shape. The Youth Employment Agency and Ghana Digital Centres signed a memorandum of understanding in July 2026 to train 2,000 young people in cloud, AI, cybersecurity and data analytics through Microsoft-certified microdegrees — a training count, with placement left open. A Training of Girls programme launched in October 2024, run with the Ghana-India Kofi Annan Centre of Excellence in ICT and the Ghana Investment Fund for Electronic Communications.

The newest programme sits outside the state. Ghana launched the National Community Media Cyber Capability Building Project on 3 August 2026 at the NCA Tower in Accra, training community journalists on cybercrime and online safety; it runs over 100 journalists from about 60 media houses, in Accra in August 2026 and Kumasi in September 2026, and is funded by the Czech government and implemented by the Africa Center for Digital Transformation with the Cyber Security Authority. Inside government the picture is thinner: there is a public-service digital skills programme covering basic digital skills and data literacy, whose governing document is not published (2025), against a December 2021 European Commission assessment that the National Information Technology Agency lacked the digital-government planning skills its platform ambitions required.

The pipeline feeding it is narrow at the top and thinly organised below. Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology sits among the strongest domestic computing programmes (2025), while the developer community it feeds is concentrated in Greater Accra and weakly organised (2025); the state runs a public jobs portal for registration, search and application that also serves public-sector recruitment. Most of the money behind that pipeline is external and Chinese: China Eximbank signed two concessional loans on 30 October 2020, one connecting five national tertiary institutions' satellite campuses to fibre, one for the Institute of Local Government Studies, following an April 2018 loan of RMB 754 million to rehabilitate thirteen technical institutes and ten polytechnics and technical universities, still part-disbursed in May 2022.

Research institutions

The clearest commitment to a research base is foreign-funded: Korea's KOICA holds a US$9 million grant to the University of Ghana under GK-IMPACT, running 2022-2027, to build an advanced ICT innovation centre and promote ICT-based start-ups. The other standing research presence in Accra is Google's artificial-intelligence research centre, first announced in 2018, which is corporate rather than public.

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

Ghana's dedicated rural internet licence class holds a single authorised provider, and the regulator records that provider as not operational (June 2025), so the licence category created to reach the unserved has nobody behind it. The build runs instead through the state fund and licence conditions: GIFEC's Rural Telephony Project remains the fund's top priority (March 2026), financed by a China Eximbank buyer's credit signed in May 2020 to build networks where mobile operators do not operate; and the rural coverage schedule attached to 5G spectrum was rewritten from licence-relative years to fixed calendar dates, 40% of the rural population by December 2029 rising to 80% by December 2035 (July 2026), expressly so that buying spectrum cannot reset a rural commitment already owed.

Capture at the point of service outside the capital is thin. Rural primary healthcare still runs on paper: CHPS compounds keep patient data on paper registers and tally sheets, with aggregates entered into DHIMS2 later at facility or district level (2025), and electronic records sit in district and regional hospitals rather than rural facilities. Rural registry offices record births on paper and pass the data upward only where infrastructure allows, and rural police case files travel physically to Accra to be digitised. Schools submit the annual EMIS census through an app, a once-a-year capture rather than record-keeping at the moment of use; a 2025 study of headteachers in Wenchi Municipality found their use of ICT for administration inconsistent and behind urban schools, constrained by electricity, connectivity and hardware.

Digital government services remain primarily urban, and Ghana Card enrolment in remote areas has needed offline tools (2024) — a pattern set by power, handsets and money rather than signal, given near-universal 3G and 4G coverage, rural electricity access well behind urban, and rural phones still mostly basic handsets. Ghana scores strongly on the rural economy itself: rural market access reached 81.8 out of 100, sixth of 54 African states and up 27.6 points over the decade (2023), with the rural economy sub-category at 76.6. Farm data stays apart, agricultural platforms having no route into other government systems (2026).

Digitalisation of sub-national government

The financial spine reaches below the national level: Ghana's integrated financial management system, built on commercial off-the-shelf software, covers treasury operations and budget preparation across both central and local government (2025). Local government is also written into the current reform: the second National Public Sector Reform Strategy spans the ministries of Local Government, Finance and Communications together with the DVLA, the human rights commission and the Passport Office (July 2026).

Below that the picture is uneven. Open government action planning reaches municipal assemblies, but participation is partial and the approach decentralised, with initiatives fragmented across ministries, departments and agencies (2024). The largest single sub-national digital investment on record is for the capital rather than the districts: Korea's development cooperation fund approved US$100 million in 2021 for the second phase of Accra's intelligent transport system, following an equal sum for the first phase in 2019.

Data

National statistics

Ghana's statistical office scores well on what it publishes and poorly on what it is built on: the World Bank's Statistical Performance Indicators put Ghana in the 70-89% band on data use and on data products but only in the 50-69% band on data services, data sources and data infrastructure (2023).

All three foundational censuses — population, agriculture and business — have been run within the last ten years, and the survey programme has three or more household, health and agriculture rounds behind it, against only two business surveys and two labour surveys (2023), leaving the economic side the thinner one. The office itself has gained ground: the 2024 Ibrahim Index scores the capacity of Ghana's statistical system at 57.4 out of 100, eighteenth of 54 African countries and up 9.2 points over the decade to 2023.

Timeliness is where the strain shows. The National Communications Authority's quarterly statistical bulletin for the third quarter of 2024 appeared around May 2025, roughly eight months after the period it reports.

Where the state has tried to measure a sector properly, the gaps show through. Ghana is one of only two African states known to have compiled an ICT satellite account, the other South Africa (2017). That account could not project the sector's contribution to GDP at all for want of data points — employment figures existed only from the 2014 business establishment survey — and its measurement of ICT gross value added came out above the published GDP figure for the whole Information and Communication sector, which the regulator read as an underestimation of the sector in the national accounts (2017).

Administrative records substitute only in part. The school census is a digitised annual return rather than record-keeping at the moment of use, the financial management system does not track spending to programme level and monitors programme and SDG performance only partially (2025), and birth registration remains incomplete. A US$1 million Hewlett Foundation grant ran from 2021 to 2025 to strengthen SDG monitoring in the statistical system.

Open data

Ghana's government has recorded the portal's failure itself: the 2024 Open Government Partnership self-assessment reports that 20 of a targeted 50 ministries, departments and agencies had uploaded data to the open data portal, blaming non-cooperation from data holders and unpopulated portals.

The Ghana Open Data Initiative has run since 2010 under the National Information Technology Agency and hosts 315 data catalogues from 22 ministries and agencies (2024), yet it carries only basic information and datasets, updated mostly by hand rather than automatically from source systems (2025). Open Data Watch's Open Data Inventory scores what a statistical office publishes online for coverage and openness; Ghana's split runs by subject: economic statistics score 6.5 to 7.0 out of ten, while the social and sectoral categories fall to between 2.5 and 4.0 across health, energy, agriculture and education facilities (2024).

Policy sits in an odd corner. The open-data instrument on the books was adopted by the Ghana Extractive Industries Transparency Initiative's multi-stakeholder group in December 2016, and binds nothing to a date — no publication timetable, no named open licence, no owner for any commitment, and integration into government systems deferred to "the long term". Across government, a data governance function is established and holistic, but housed inside another institution, with the strategy behind it still in preparation (2025).

The systems themselves are barely documented in public. Papers on the government cloud, the service portal, e-procurement and the financial and revenue systems exist internally but are not published, while the digital transformation strategy, the data governance arrangements and the public investment management system are not published at all (2025).

A right-to-information law is in force with a working request mechanism (2025), but it has not moved what the public can reach: accessibility of public records scores 49.8 out of 100 in the 2024 Ibrahim Index, eighth of 54, and has shifted 0.1 points across the decade to 2023 that spans the Act's passage, while disclosure rose 11.4 points to 50.0, ninth of 54. The Right to Information Commission has since fined public institutions en masse for missing their statutory reporting deadline (August 2026).

Use of satellite data

No national space or geospatial data policy had been adopted as at August 2026.

Finance

New investments

The largest new money in Ghana's digital sector is private, and it is an acceleration rather than an addition: MTN's three-year programme from 2026 puts US$1.1bn behind network, fibre and data-centre build where the previous commitment spread US$1bn over five years, roughly tripling annual capital intensity on the company's own numbers. The programme is announced rather than contracted, and MTN Ghana's capital spending fell sharply in the first half of 2026.

Around twenty external financing commitments to Ghana's digital sector are on the record, with start years from 2014 to 2026 and windows running to 2030, together worth roughly US$2.6 billion attributable to Ghana. That is money committed and signed rather than money disbursed, and it mixes operator capital expenditure, equity, grants and sovereign lending. Connectivity alone takes about three-fifths of it and training a further tenth, while digital identity draws a single small commitment.

On the official side, China Eximbank is the largest single source, with five loans signed between 2018 and 2020 funding distance learning, rural telephony, national-security communications and the rehabilitation of technical institutes and polytechnics. The World Bank's US$200 million Ghana Digital Acceleration Project runs 2022-2027 across broadband, digital financial services, digital public services and skills, and pays for the expansion of Ghana.gov. Korea's development fund approved a US$100 million concessional loan in 2021 for the second phase of Accra's intelligent transport system, after a first US$100 million phase approved in 2019. Germany is funding a EUR 12.5 million programme on digital transformation for inclusive entrepreneurship over 2023-2026, premised on unregistered micro-enterprises having gained least from digitalisation.

The European Union is the conspicuous absence. Its 2021-2027 programme for Ghana sets no digital priority area and makes no digital allocation, treating digital as transversal across green growth, sustainable cities and governance, so Ghanaian govtech is funded out of other sectors' envelopes, and the indicative EUR 203 million behind it covers 2021-2024 alone, with the 2025-2027 tranche reserved to a later decision.

Against the dollar sums announced around artificial intelligence, the ministry's own account of the National AI Strategy launch in April 2026 carries no money figure at all.

MoUs and other agreements

Ghana's partnership with Digital Policy Alert on digital governance has no published memorandum text, funding arrangement, timetable or deliverable attached to it, and stands as an announced working relationship rather than an instrument (August 2026). The one signed digital agreement of substance is a July 2026 memorandum between the Youth Employment Agency and Ghana Digital Centres on Microsoft-certified training in cloud, artificial intelligence, cybersecurity and data analytics.

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